

Once I'm ready to travel, I'm a big fan of moving light. For packing light, google '*tim ferriss: how to travel the world with 10 pounds*'. Also, I hate planning too much. I just go and figure out by asking the locals over what to see. This often brings new elements of surprise during the journey.

Funding the vacation

If you don't have any savings right now, take a small vacation this year. Then set yourself up for a big one with prudent planning.

How to set yourself up: If your next big vacation is in 12 months, divide the total expenses by 12 and establish that as your RD amount. If the total plan costs 40,000, make 3500 go into the RD automatically from your salary account. You'll be booking the flights sometime in-between but don't stop the RD. Pay for the flights by downsizing other expenses. When you have 42k+interest in 12 months, take 30k for this trip and leave the rest in a FD (you should pay for the flight by skimping for a month when it's booked). This 12k+interest in FD will serve as your next vacation flight money. Keep repeating this RD cycle of 3500 so that you can take vacations every year. Prices for travel and flights rarely increase as inflation around the world is abysmal. Plus, several budget airlines are arising, that put customer's needs for cheap travel at the forefront of their operations.

On occasions that you're unable to take big vacations, lower the RD amount and travel domestically. Most of the Indian origin flights are cheap many months in advance and you can follow the same methodology outlined.

From an external viewpoint, travel seems expensive. But once you start traveling, things always are much cheaper than they are from the outside. Here's an illustration:

Expenses for a week in Bali	Things to do
Rent: 10,500 for a 4-star hotel or 3,500 for a hostel Round trip: 15,000 - 18,000 on a Air Asia flight.	Break it down to a Target Daily income and it becomes ₹ 110 per day - easy peasy. Now, do you need that cafe lunch or can you brown bag something?